Session 2

2025-02-02

1 – Finishing the tunnel

~22:00, 22 Marpenoth 1489 DR

1. The heroes are at the keep, picking up after the tunnel disaster and Sinsong's resurrection. The night has not let up; the assault is still pressing on Greenest from every side.
2. **Tarbaw** briefs them: civilians are sheltering in the temple of Chauntea; the church is under attack and needs relief. Watching the party still bandaged from the tunnel disaster, he presses three of the keep's last healing potions on them before sending them out.
3. The party returns to the lower tunnel and finishes clearing it of the residual giant rats and stray spiders left from the disastrous spider-nest fight.
4. The tunnel is now fully cleared and rehabilitated as a covert way in and out, beyond the raider line.
5. Sinsong, still recovering, remains at the keep helping the wounded. Eguzkilore takes the battlements, pinning raiders to cover his friends' sortie.
6. The party emerges from the cleared tunnel and runs straight into a small kobold patrol.
7. The fight is short. Nuberroca subdues one kobold *alive* — pinning rather than killing — and questions it on the spot.
8. ***[EPIC]*** The kobold is collaborative but renders barely any useful information. Rather than dispatch it, Nuberroca restrains the kobold and keeps it as a *"pet"*, strapped to his chest like a baby.
9. Approaching the temple, Nyx and Mialee scout ahead in good stealth; Nuberroca trails slightly behind with Amidamaru and the restrained kobold. The goliath's bulk forces him to hang back rather than lead, and even there his heavy footfalls keep threatening to give them away.
10. The two scouts carry the party past further patrols unseen.

2 – Sanctuary rescue

~23:00, 22 Marpenoth 1489 DR

1. The temple of Chauntea is surrounded by an external wall, already breached at the front by the time the party arrives. From the outside, they can see a loose patrol circling the perimeter — three cultists, ten kobolds, and two ambush drakes, dispersed.
2. The party closes on the wall as soon as the patrol leaves the area. Mialee climbs onto Nuberroca to peer into the temple compound, and from the elevated angle she spots two more enemy groups:
    - At the back door, four cultists and four kobolds — clustered tightly — are trying to burn it down, failing miserably and producing a prodigious smoke cloud that obscures the area.
    - At the front door across the compound, a menacing-looking cultist leader directs two cultists working a battering ram against the temple door, with six kobolds standing guard around them.
3. The rhythmic thuds of the ram already echo through the temple — the party can hear them clearly even before Mialee gets eyes on the front-door group.
4. The party scales the perimeter wall at the rear, falls on the arson detail, and kills them swiftly under cover of the cultists' own smoke. The ram keeps battering the main door.
5. The cuts the cultists landed on Nuberroca start closing with a *blue glow* while Mialee strips the robes off two of the dead cultists — one for herself and a spare for a partner — before pushing in.
6. Inside the temple, the civilians are panicked; calming them takes several minutes, and the heroes succeed only with the help of **Eadyan Falconmoon**, the half-elf priest in charge of the temple. Through the whole dialogue, the front-door ram keeps beating, each strike echoing through the sanctuary — a constant reminder that they are still in danger.
7. As the group is finishing the extraction through the back door, the main door finally gives way in a shower of splinters — the cultist leader's ram team is breaking through. At almost the same moment, outside, the loose patrol has drifted dangerously close to the back door.
8. Mialee creates a magical illusion at the main entry, pulling the attention of both cultist groups back toward the temple's entrance. The party uses the gap to slip out the back of the temple.
9. At the perimeter wall, Amidamaru and Nuberroca lift and steady the civilians across between them, one by one — slow but unobserved. Up close, the kobold strapped to Nuberroca's chest sets off fresh panic in some of the civilians as the goliath hoists them up.
10. Reaching the river with all civilians unharmed, the group heads back along the stream toward the keep.

3 – Ambush in the river

~00:00, 23 Marpenoth 1489 DR

1. The way back follows the stream in the dead of night. Frogs croak in the shallows. The only visible lights are the distant fires and a luminous stone Amidamaru gave Nuberroca to keep them from stumbling in the dark.
2. Almost back at the tunnel mouth, the stone gives them away: a cultist patrol — five kobolds and three cultists directed by an acolyte — spots the light and ambushes the party.
3. The opening is brutal: kobolds fire their slings from cover along the bank while cultists rush in from concealed positions among the trees. The party is caught flat-footed.
4. Panic takes the civilians — some plunge into the shallows, others crash into the underbrush along the bank. **Eadyan** tries to hold them together, but the chaos outruns him; within breaths, **half the group is lost in the dark**.
5. Nuberroca answers with a counter-charge, axe up, the cloth-strapped kobold on his chest squealing as the goliath crashes into the lead cultists. Nyx moves closer to the goliath, shooting arrows as she goes.
6. The patrol's first blows land hard on the charging goliath, but a *blue glow* runs across each fresh cut and closes it partway.
7. The barbarian's charge halts when the acolyte commands him to retreat. With his *body betraying him*, the goliath falls back, leaving Nyx exposed.
8. In Nuberroca's absence the patrol surges around Nyx — kobolds and cultists pile on the small ranger, landing hits before she can give ground.
9. Nyx drops the lead kobold with a precise thrust of her shortsword, but the rest keep coming; she holds, bloodied and pressed.
10. Amidamaru intervenes to save Nyx, wading in beside her. He cuts down two kobolds in the surge before a cultist drives a spear into him and drops him.
11. Nuberroca recovers his senses, downing the acolyte with a precise axe throw as an act of revenge.
12. Hidden along the bank, Mialee picks her moment and subdues one of the remaining cultists with a clean knockout. With the acolyte dead and one of theirs taken, the rest of the patrol breaks for the trees.
13. Nuberroca hurls a hand-axe after one of the fleeing cultists; the throw buries itself between the shoulder blades and drops him short of the treeline.
14. With the fight done, the goliath turns to Amidamaru — the artificer's bleeding has stopped at some point in the chaos, breath shallow but holding.
15. Sizing up Amidamaru's deadweight, the goliath decides he can't carry both the artificer and the kobold strapped to his chest. He rips the bundled kobold off and hurls it up into the high branches of a nearby tree — out of reach, out of earshot, unable to alert anyone.
16. Only as he stoops to lift Amidamaru does the goliath see the obvious: the stream will carry the weight for him. He ties a rope around the artificer and drags him through the shallows, the current bearing what his shoulders no longer have to — the kobold-throw, in hindsight, unnecessary.
17. The party rounds up the scattered civilians, returning to the keep with the rescued people, the captured cultist, and the dragged Amidamaru.

4 – Recovery at the keep

1. Inside the keep the air is loud with the night's wounded — soldiers and townsfolk alike. **Eadyan** and the rescued civilians are taken in; healers move to those who need them most.
2. Sinsong, helping at the keep tonight rather than in the field, meets the party as they bring the cultist in and takes the prisoner's robe — disguise material for whatever the night still has.
3. The cultist is then handed to **Escobert the Red**, who sets to interrogation in one of the cellars below the great hall.
4. The party finds a quiet corner and takes a short rest. This one is *unusually restorative*: aches fade faster than they should, lesser cuts close on their own, and old wounds feel lighter by the end of the hour. The party comes out of it cleaner than anticipated.
5. Once rested, they take the time to restock and reset. Keep quartermasters refill ammunition; Nuberroca gets a fresh pair of hand-axes; the smiths patch dented armour and re-edge chipped weapons; the party tends to the wounds the night left them.
6. Refreshed and rearmed, the party climbs to the keep's battlements to find Tarbaw and learn what the night still wants of them.

5 - Dragon attack

~01:30, 23 Marpenoth 1489 DR

1. The party reaches **Tarbaw** at the parapet, mid-conversation about the night's run of missions, when one of the watch guards shouts the warning — *the dragon is coming* — his voice fraying with terror as he points to the sky.
2. The blue dragon arrives fast, opening from above with a *lightning breath* that sweeps the rooftop in a single arc, leaving a scorched line in the stone and the remains of a guard smoldering.
3. The dragon dives in for its first close pass, sweeping through the battlements: it lashes with its claws, snatches one guard from the parapet and devours him without slowing, raking Tarbaw in passing — face cuts re-opened, blood pouring.
4. By the end of that first pass two of the keep's guards are dead and several more wounded; the parapet is slick with blood.
5. Mialee, frightened beyond reason, presses herself behind cover and runs down the stairs, choosing her safety over the fight.
6. Nuberroca answers with axe and rage, charging into the open to challenge the dragon directly. Nyx and Amidamaru engage from the parapet with everything they have, slowly overcoming their fears.
7. Challenged, the dragon pulls back to range. Most of its attacks come at distance now — the lightning breath sweeping the rooftop again and again.
8. Between passes the party keeps firing on it: Amidamaru looses arrow after arrow, Nuberroca hurls hand-axes when its arcs bring it within reach, and the keep guards work their crossbows from the wall. Most of the volley shatters against the dragon's powerful scales — arrows snapping, bolts skittering off into the dark, hand-axes chiming like struck anvils.
9. ***[EPIC]*** Nyx, sighting between the dragon's passes, threads a longbow shot into one of its eyes — a *precise arrow* that scores where the scales don't shield. The dragon pulls higher with a roar of rage, blood streaking the side of its head.
10. On the next close pass, the dragon dives in to rake Nuberroca's flank with its claws before pulling up; the goliath's retaliating axe-stroke opens a cut along its foreleg as it banks away.
11. After a lightning discharge that only wounds one guard, the dragon dives in again, snatching another guard from the parapet — a snapping bite, and the man is gone.
12. On its next pass, the dragon slashes Nuberroca again and lifts a guard off the wall, hurling him over the parapet — the man falls to his death on the ground far below.
13. With the parapet near-empty around them and another claw-rake bearing in, the surviving party retreats off the rooftop into the stairwell down to the keep — the doorway narrow enough to deny the dragon's bulk.
14. The dragon presses against the stair opening from above, forcing a foreleg through, claws raking blindly for the heroes as they crouch below the threshold.
15. Nuberroca, axe braced under the lintel, lands a clean stroke on the reaching claw — not deep, but enough to draw blood and sting.
16. ***[EPIC]*** Bleeding from the eye-shot, the foreleg cut, and now the wound on its claw, the dragon pulls its leg back out of the stairwell, looks down at the heroes saying *"esperaba a un grupo de héroes, no me han pagado para esto"*, and turns away from the village.
17. The party watches it vanish into the night, the keep still standing.
18. They climb back up onto the rooftop and turn to the wreckage — wounded guards strewn across the parapet, the dead among them, and Tarbaw unconscious in his own blood — and set to tending whoever can still be saved.
19. As the party works through the parapet's wounded, Tarbaw recovers quickly — by the time they lift him clear, his bleeding has stopped and his eyes are flickering open.